

Saturday, August 13

Matthew was up by 7, Peter by 7:30. Peter watched cartoons with Erin for a half hour and then lay on the floor until 11:45. Matthew nudged him occasionally to see if he might move. I watched part of an Expo-Pirates game. Cheryl went downtown to buy the winter coat she had put on hold a few days ago. Cheryl returned home by 12:30, shortly after the rest of us finished lunch. She bought a different coat from Eaton's, black, along with a sweater and black pants, a shirt for Peter, a new sleeper for Matthew. After Cheryl finished eating we went into the back yard to pull some Johnny Jump-ups, Cheryl's idea of a flower that threatens to take over the grass. Peter played with Erin in the basement. Matthew was in the playpen, talking to us or stepping on the toy van in order to climb over the rail. He mimics Cheryl. "Get down," he'll say as soon as Cheryl's said it. We worked until 4. Matthew went to sleep. Peter and I watched some track and field from Helsinki. Erin came by and they went to Devon's. I practised the guitar. Cheryl cleaned vegetables. For supper we had corn on the cob.

We were tired but found something funny about Peter's questions: "What is energy?" "It's something in constant shortage which your parents try to conserve."

After supper Cheryl tried to rest. Peter, Matthew and I went into the basement. Peter played space invaders with a camp stove, Matthew chewed a dice eraser and I played guitar. Peter went to the bathroom. He came back down and told us that the noise keeping us downstairs was keeping Cheryl up. Peter had a long bath and a snack before going to bed at 8. Matthew was wide awake and walked for a while, but after a bath and 1½ bottles in Cheryl's lap he went to bed. I could hear them giggle in his room. Cheryl was still laughing when she came out. He had been reaching through the bars and pulling her mouth close to kiss her, then he would roll onto his back and flop his arms. Soon he turned onto his side, clapped his hands together, patted his head, scrubbed his hair and slept.